

Mataupu 13 / Chapter 13

Pō Fakamanatu mo Pō Fiafia | Commemorative Nights and Festive Nights

Tuvalu	English
Mata o Muna 13	Chapter 13
Pō Fakamanatu mo Pō Fiafia	Commemorative Nights and Festive Nights
<i>Fakatūmau: A te mata o muna i Peretānia e lahi ake mo fakamatala. E i ai i ai a te fānauga lahi e fakamatala i Pō Lahi mo fakamatalaga uke ake o Pō o Potopotoga mo Pō o Tefolaha. Vakai ki mata o muna Peretānia!</i> Te mata o muna tenei e fakamatala i ai a pō fakamanatu fakapogai o tino Nanumea i te olaga mo nohoga o te fenua e iloga i ai te olaga fiafia mo te fai mea fakatahitahi o ana tino. E i ai mo pō fakamanatu e mailoga loa i ai a tino Nanumea, pelā mo Pō o Tefolaha. Ko lātou ailoa e fakamanatu te o Tefolaha, i te lalolagi katoa hēai ake hoki. Pō fakamanatu ake e pau mo fenua i Tuvalu, pelā mo te Pō Fāfine io me Pō Gātama. Ka ko e iai mo hekehekega i faifaiga Nanumea i pō konā i a fenua ake. Pelā mo matuafo (ko fakatuagane o tamana o tamaliki), lātou ni ofo mai i te fanaumaiga, e fakatino loa mo te Pō Gātama. I pō fakamanatu katoa, te fau faka Nanumea he iloga loa o tino Nanumea, kae heke hoki loa mai fau o fenua ake tana manogi mo ana kai. Pō 'Lahi mo Te Pō o Tefolaha A te Pō o Tefolaha ni kāmata o fakatū kae fakamanatu i te 1922, i te taimi ni katoa i ai a te lupeli (50 tauhaga) o te okoatuga o te 'Tala Lelei' ki Nanumea. Ni mafaufau ake i ai a te faifeau ke fakamanatu a te pō tenei. Kae ni tai faigatā ailoa a te fakataunuga o te fakamoemoega tenei, i te mea lā koi tai tokouke hoki ailoa koi tūmau ailoa a te ifo ki tupua (atua mua o te fenua), kae e pelā hoki mo tapuaki o lātou ki a Tefolaha, te atua fakahili o lātou i pō mua.	<i>Note: The English version of this chapter is much more detailed. There you will find a general overview describing events in the Pō Lahi holiday season as well as more informative descriptions of the Pō o Potopotoga and the Pō o Tefolaha. Please be sure to consult the English chapter!</i> This chapter describes the important commemorative nights of Nanumean people in the life and customs of the land, which are known for their joyful living and communal activities of the people. There are also commemorative nights that are well known to Nanumean people, such as the Night of Tefolaha. They alone commemorate Tefolaha, nowhere else in the world. Other commemorative nights are common to islands in Tuvalu, such as Women's Night or Youth Night. But there are differences in Nanumean practices on those nights compared to other islands. For example, the matuafo (the father's brothers of the children), who traditionally gave gifts at birth, perform especially at Youth Night. At all commemorative nights, the Nanumean way is very distinctive of Nanumean people, though the styles of other islands also bring their fragrance and foods. The Big Nights and The Night of Tefolaha The Night of Tefolaha was first established and commemorated in 1922, at the time of the Golden Jubilee (50 years) of the arrival of the Gospel to Nanumea. The pastor thought to commemorate this night. But it was not easy to accomplish this goal, because there were still quite a few who continued to worship idols (the old gods of the land), and also those who continued to make offerings to Tefolaha, their ancestral guardian in earlier times.

Ni taumafai mālosi a te faifeau, fakatahi mo lātou koa talitonu, me ke fai a te pō tenei (te lupeli) mo aso e fakamaonigina i ai me koa tiakina katoatoa e lātou a olotou atua mua kolā e māhāni o tapuaki a lātou ki ai. Ni iku mo te manuia a te taumafaiga tenei, telā ni fakatū i ai a te mā e fakamanatu i ai a te feagaiga tenei. Ni fakatū a te mā tenei i te gāloto o te fa'kai kae pili ki te āhiga o te fenua.

Fakatahi ki ai ko te 'kaiga lahi ni fai i te āhiga, telā koa tai i ai a iloa he hekega lahi o te pō tenei me ko fakafiafiaga koa fai a iloa i te pō katoa, fai fātele kae 'kai. Ko lātou kolā e fia tuhi a olotou tofi ekalesia, tiakono me ni failauga, e olo lātou ki te ofisa o te faifeau o tuhi a olotou tofi i ai. Ko toeaina o te fenua e tūmau hoki a iloa o fai a te olotou galuega telā ko te fakakolekolega o tamatāne mo tamāfine ke faka'ka a olotou putulama.

A te putulama, a tona uiga he lama toetoe. I te taimi telā o te fakaoinga i te taimi o te Pō o Tefolaha, a te galuega a toeaina ko te olo o fakakolekole a tamatāne pelā hoki mo tamāfine ke talia e lātou ke fai a olotou āvaga, kae fai koa tonu mo te tamaliki fāfine, koa fakailoa i ai ki ona mātua, kae fai koa tonu a iloa faka'lei, koa kini i ai a te pele, o fakailoa me 'koa kā a te putulama' a te tamatāne tenei.

E fakamanatu a te pō nei i te pō 8 o Ianuali i tauhaga takitahi kae ni iku ke fakaoinga a te pō tenei ko te Pō o Tefolaha. A Tefolaha ko te tamana o tāgata Nanumea, kae ni tapuaki hoki a lātou ki ai i te tulaga e pelā a Tefolaha me he atua o lātou.

Fakamuli ifo ni mafaua a te faifeau Samoa ko Iosefa ke 'fuli a te igoa o te pō tenei mai te Pō o Tefolaha ki te Aso Pati, telā e fakaloa penei. 'Ko te Aso Penetekoso o Alo o Tefolaha mō Iesu.' Kae i pō nei, pelā a iloa me 'loto a te tokouega ke fakatūmau a iloa a te igoa ko te 'Pō o Tefolaha.'

Fakavae Tupe

Fakapotopotoga katoa, he fenua me he mālō, e 'tau a iloa o i ai a te mea tenei ko te sene mo fai a tona fakavae, telā koa mafai i ai o fakataunugina a ona manakoga valevale. A

The pastor tried hard, together with those who believed, so that this night (the Jubilee) would be a confirmed day on which they would completely abandon their old gods that they were accustomed to worshipping. This effort was successful, and a stone was erected to commemorate this covenant. This stone was erected in the center of the village near the meeting house of the land.

Along with this a great feast was held in the meeting house, and there was indeed a great difference in this night — it was a celebration that went on all night, with fātele dancing and feasting. Those who wished to register their church roles, as deacons or lay preachers, went to the pastor's office to register their roles. The elders of the land continued their work of gathering young men and women to announce their putulama (marriage engagements).

The putulama means an almost-engagement. In that practice during the Night of Tefolaha, the work of the elders was to go and gather young men and also young women to accept their marriage proposals. When it was confirmed for a young woman, her parents were informed, and when it was properly confirmed, the ring was placed, announcing that this young man's 'putulama has been lit.'

This night is commemorated on the 8th of January each year, and it has come to be called the Night of Tefolaha. Tefolaha is the ancestor of Nanumean people, and they also offered worship to him in the way that they treated Tefolaha as a god.

Later, the Samoan pastor Iosefa thought to change the name of this night from the Night of Tefolaha to the Party Day, saying: 'It is the Pentecost Day of the Children of Tefolaha for Jesus.' But today, it seems that the majority wish to keep the name 'Night of Tefolaha.'

The Community Financial Foundation

Every community, every land and government, must have a financial foundation so that its various needs can be met. As far as is known about Nanumea, it

Nanumea i te mea e iloa atu nei, atu lā ko ia hoki ailoa ko te fenua muamua i loto i te Tuvalu ni kāmata e ia o fai a te mea tenei ki te fai tautino sene.

Ni oko ake he manatu, me atu lā koa tai matauke ailoa mo sene a te fenua. Ka e iloa ake nei, me koa oko ailoa i te hē 'lei a te tausiga o sene, a tupe ni 'tala faka italafu, kae ko te tokoukega e hē ti aga o 'moli a olotou kai talafu.

Ni iku ake i te fenua, me e 'tau ke fakamanatu a te Pō o te Fakavae Tupe a te fenua i tauhaga katoa i te pō muamua o Iulai. Telā koa mafai i ai o fakalogo'logo katoa a te fenua ki tala tupe koa 'folagina i te pō tenā.

Pō Fāfine

E fakamanatu fakatahi i tauhaga, e mailoga i ai fāfine koa malōlō mai haga a lātou i olotou fale, pelā hoki mo mea fai a te fenua. E māhani o fakamanatu e fāfine te pō o lātou ia Tesema pō 10. Fāfine katoa, mailoga lātou tai mātua atu, e aofia katoa i te pō fakamanatu tenei.

A polokalame mo te Pō Fāfine koa oti ailoa ni fakatoka mai mua o te pō fakamanatu i te ofisa o taipola fāfine. Fāfine e tatau ailoa o fakagaligali, tī ki lava fou, malele, ligi, taulima, mo manogi faka te fenua, kae 'kai ki meakai 'gali e fakatokagina e kāiga.

Faigamea o te Pō Fāfine e māhani o kāmata i te pogipogi, kae māhani nei o tolu a pō manafai e talia katoatoa ni fāfine i te fonotaga māhina: te pō fā, pō lima mo te pō ono. Kae moe hoki ki te āhiga. Fāfine e fai fiafiaga a lātou, inu tī i te pogipogi, mo kaiga i te tutonu mo te afiafi.

I te pogipogi o te pō ono e fai i ai te alofa ki faifeau, te māhani ko meakai mo teutuhi sene i ai. Mai tua o te alofa koa fai i ai te manauo, uhuuhuga o pehe ki lomātua mo toeaina Nanumea kae kave mealofa pelā mo hopu kaukau, hopu mulu lava, mo mea foliki ake hoki.

Pō Fakamanatu Ake

was actually the first island in Tuvalu to begin doing this through regular monetary contributions.

The thought came that perhaps the land's funds were sufficient. But it became known that the management of money was not good — money was spent on loans, and most people did not meet their loan repayments.

It was decided in the land that the Night of the Community Financial Foundation should be commemorated every year on the first night of July. That way all the land could hear the financial reports presented on that night.

Women's Night

Commemorated together each year, this is known for women resting from their household work, as well as from community activities. Women customarily celebrate their night on December 10th. All women, even the eldest, are all included in this commemorative night.

The program for Women's Night is always arranged beforehand at the women's committee office. Women must dress beautifully, wearing new clothes, with necklaces, earrings, bracelets, and traditional fragrances, and feast on special foods prepared by families.

The activities of Women's Night customarily begin in the morning, and now it is usually three nights if all women are received at the monthly meeting: the fourth night, fifth night, and sixth night. They also sleep in the meeting house. Women have their celebrations, drink tea in the morning, and feast at midday and in the afternoon.

On the morning of the sixth night, a gift is given to the pastor — customarily food and some money. After the gift there is the manauo, singing of hymns to the elderly women and elders of Nanumea, and gifts are brought such as bathing soap, body lotion soap, and other small items.

Other Commemorative Nights

Pō fakamanatu ake e māhāni ailoa hoki o fai a fiafiaga e mailoga i ai te olaga fiafia o tino Nanumea i te fai mea fakatahitahi.

Pō Gātama: E māhāni o fakamanatu ia Oketopa pō 10. Tamaliki e fakatoka e lātou te lotu i te pogipogi mo te afiafi, koa olo i ai o kai i olotou mātuafo. Tamaliki e tī ki lava fou e fakatokagina e mātuafo.

Pō o te Aogāpehe Fāfine: E fakamanatu ia lulai i tauhaga takitahi. Te kau pehe tenei e māhāni o uhu i te lotu fāfine māhina e fai i aso Wenerei i muri o te komunio Sande. Ni kāmata i te 1955, ko te kau pehe ni fakamanatu tona lupeli 50 tauhaga ia lulai 2005. I tauhaga takitahi fāfine e fatu pehe fou kae akoako i ai a lulai e ōmai. Ko ta lātou aso fakamanatu e kāmata mo te lotu falesā kae fakatahi i te āhiga mo te aso o kaiga, tautalaga, fakakata mo siva.

Mata, e i ai hoki ni pō fakamanatu ake o Nanumea? E tau o faulu ikonei mo olou fakamatalaga.

Other commemorative nights also customarily hold celebrations that are known for the joyful life of Nanumean people in their communal activities.

Youth Night: Customarily commemorated on October 10th. Children arrange their own church services in the morning and afternoon, then go to eat at their matuafo's (father's brothers') homes. Children are dressed in new clothes provided by the matuafo.

Night of the Women's Choir: Celebrated in July each year. This choir regularly sings at the women's church service, which is held each month on the Wednesday after Sunday's communion church service. Started in 1955, the choir celebrated its 50th year Jubilee in July 2005. Each year women compose new hymns and practice them as July nears. Their day of celebration begins with a church service and then they gather in the āhiga for a day of feasting, speeches, joking and dancing.

Now, are there other commemorative nights of Nanumea? You are invited to add them here with your descriptions.